



THE TRIAL COURT OF MASSACHUSETTS
EXECUTIVE OFFICE OF THE TRIAL COURT

John Adams Courthouse
One Pemberton Square, 1M
Boston, MA 02108

Heidi E. Brieger
Chief Justice of the Trial Court

Thomas G. Ambrosino
Court Administrator

October 18, 2024

Via Email

Justin Silverman, Executive Director
New England First Amendment Coalition
111 Milk Street
Westborough, Massachusetts 01581
Nefac.org

Re: Public Kiosks

Dear Executive Director Silverman:

I am writing in response to your October 9, 2024, letter to former Trial Court Chief Justice Jeffrey A. Locke regarding court records available at public access terminal kiosks in courthouses. The Trial Court appreciates your thoughts and input as we work to make as much information available to the public as possible.

You referenced a concern about public access terminals being out of order in some courthouses. This has been a priority for our IT department, and the non-working terminals have all been repaired or replaced. In addition, there was a period last year when, due to vendor software security concerns, courthouse kiosks that provide public access to MassCourts information were not fully operational. We believe that caused the slow operation in Worcester referenced in your letter. The security issues have been fully resolved, and, to the best of our knowledge, the kiosks are all operating properly.

You also wrote about specific concerns regarding the availability of public access terminals in courthouses and suggested two solutions: that the Trial Court provide two terminals in each location; and that the Clerks' offices impose a one-hour time limit on individuals using the public terminals. Unfortunately, in many courthouses, we do not have the physical capability to provide two public kiosks. With respect to the time limit on usage, that suggestion is under active consideration.

Please note that we are working diligently to improve accessibility to our public documents. Earlier this year, we added over 50 million documents online on MassCourts, which significantly increased the availability of documents to those accessing the Trial Court's records through the internet. We continue to work toward our goal of making as much information as possible available online so that the information on MassCourts.org closely mirrors the information available at the public access terminals.

Sincerely,

Thomas G. Ambrosino
Court Administrator